FIGURE 11.1: THE BOUNDARY SPECTRUM

Diagnostic Spectrum: The Porous Martyr, The Pliant Boundary, and The Stone Fortress

DEFICIT ZONE

The Porous Martyr

- Absorbs everyone's panic
- Cannot say "No" without guilt
- Resentful over-functioning
- "If I don't fix it, all collapses"

ENDPOINT: SUDDEN COLLAPSE

★ OPTIMAL THRESHOLD

The Pliant Boundary

- Holds space with dignity
- Permeable to love & tender grief
- Asks: "Whose pain am I fixing?"
- Clear, unhurried, reciprocal

ENDPOINT: SUSTAINABLE CARE

EXCESS ZONE

The Stone Fortress

- Impenetrable emotional wall
- Rigid bureaucratic rules
- Cynical invulnerability
- Complete insulation from pain

ENDPOINT: ISOLATED NUMBNESS